

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 998

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor St. Agnes Academy on the occasion of its 175th anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are proud to recognize those hallowed educational institutions that are celebrating momentous occasions in their long and storied histories; and

WHEREAS, St. Agnes Academy of Memphis is one such distinguished institution that is celebrating its 175th anniversary in 2026; and

WHEREAS, in 1851, six Dominican Sisters from Kentucky arrived in Memphis on January 1st to establish a school for girls, and St. Agnes Female Academy opened one month later with day and boarding students; and

WHEREAS, the Academy was originally located at Vance and Orleans, which was then in a suburb of Memphis; enrollment grew rapidly in its first year, exceeding fifty students and prompting immediate expansion of the original building; and

WHEREAS, throughout its history, the Dominican Sisters persevered through extraordinary hardships, including ministering to wounded soldiers during the Civil War, enduring yellow fever epidemics in 1867, 1873, and 1878, and rebuilding after devastating fires in 1878 and 1900, yet the school never closed—a testament to the resilience of its founders and the enduring strength of its mission; and

WHEREAS, St. Agnes Academy continued to grow and thrive, adding new wings in 1911, establishing The Memphis Conservatory of Music in 1918 as a major center for formal music education in the city, and relocating in 1951 to its current campus on Walnut Grove Road after a century of educating young women in Memphis; and

WHEREAS, in 1956, ground was broken on the same property for St. Dominic School, a Catholic elementary school for boys operated by the Dominican Sisters in conjunction with St. Agnes Academy; and

WHEREAS, over the years, numerous improvements and expansions have enhanced the campus, including the addition of Siena Hall, the Veritas Research Center and Distance Learning Center, the Davis Early Childhood Center, and the Math and Science Center; and

WHEREAS, students of St. Agnes Academy have excelled in athletics, winning numerous regional and state titles in golf, soccer, bowling, track, and tennis, and the school was awarded the Best of the Preps Award for the Female Division in 2011 and 2012; and

WHEREAS, guided by the Dominican Pillars of study, prayer, community, and service, students collectively volunteer more than 18,000 hours of service annually, embodying the spirit of faith and commitment to truth that have defined St. Agnes Academy for generations; and

WHEREAS, today, St. Agnes Academy stands as the oldest continuously operating school in Memphis and the oldest Dominican school in the country, and it is fitting that we honor this venerable institution on its 175th anniversary; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor St. Agnes Academy on the occasion of its 175th anniversary, extending to this esteemed institution our best wishes for continued success in the years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

